

Sovereignty and Pluralism - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Sovereignty and Pluralism

TEN-SESSION CORE PATH • PRACTICE • OPTIONAL ADVANCED • REGISTER NOTES

1 Concept Map and Definitions

2 Classical Characteristics and Core Distinctions

3 Bodin, Grotius and Hobbes

4 Locke, Rousseau, Bentham and Austin

5 Pluralist Critique, Kautilya, Traps and Sources

6 Theses and Directive Decoding

7 Monist Argument and Pluralist Reply

8 Named Evidence Units

9 Worked Analysis and Mark-Scaled Architecture

10 Cautious Indian Application

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Sovereignty and Pluralism - Solved Practice Workbook	3
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	3
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	15
ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS	18

Sovereignty and Pluralism - Solved Practice Workbook

Generation: learner-v2:g2 **PYQ ownership:** Every verified question below retains the primary owner recorded in the source ledger.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

MCQ 1

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Sovereignty**?

A. supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180). B. the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195). C. legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193). D. people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return to anarchy (PDF pp.182-183).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sovereignty** with **supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180)**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 2

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180)**.

A. Locke B. Sovereignty C. MacIver D. Political sovereignty

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180)**. with **Sovereignty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 3

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Legal sovereignty**?

A. These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition. B. Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187). C. Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190). D. people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense (PDF p.182).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Legal sovereignty** with **Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190)**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 4

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190)**.

A. Rousseau B. Kautilya (secondary-source comparator) C. Popular sovereignty D. Legal sovereignty

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).** with **Legal sovereignty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 5

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Political sovereignty**?

A. The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190). B. sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203). C. pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority. D. the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Political sovereignty** with **The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 6

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).**

A. Bentham B. Political sovereignty C. "Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies." D. Pluralism

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).** with **Political sovereignty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 7

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Popular sovereignty**?

A. internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign control in international relations (PDF pp.179-182). B. sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181). C. The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193). D. sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Popular sovereignty** with **The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 8

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193).**

A. Austin B. Sovereignty C. Monistic sovereignty D. Popular sovereignty

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193).** with **Popular sovereignty**. The other

options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 9

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Pluralism**?

A. the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198). B. de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188). C. about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign state from foreign control. D. sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist formulation (PDF pp.183-185).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Pluralism** with **the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 10

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198)**.

A. Laski B. Pluralism C. Legal sovereignty D. The five classical characteristics of sovereignty

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198)** with **Pluralism**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 11

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Monistic sovereignty**?

A. legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193). B. people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return to anarchy (PDF pp.182-183). C. the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195). D. Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Monistic sovereignty** with **the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 12

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195)**.

A. MacIver B. Political sovereignty C. State vs government D. Monistic sovereignty

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195).** with **Monistic sovereignty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 13

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **The five classical characteristics of sovereignty**?

A. These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition. B. Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187). C. people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense (PDF p.182). D. MacIver concludes that the state should coordinate and resolve conflicts between associations rather than determine their purposes, because the "common interest" is never exhaustively represented by the state alone - the partial interests of many associations are also part of it (PDF pp.204-206).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **The five classical characteristics of sovereignty** with **These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 14

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.**

A. Kautilya (secondary-source comparator) B. The five classical characteristics of sovereignty C. Popular sovereignty D. Internal vs external sovereignty

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.** with **The five classical characteristics of sovereignty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 15

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **State vs government**?

A. pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority. B. the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193). C. sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203). D. the supplied Socio-Political Philosophy synopsis

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **State vs government** with **sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203)..** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 16

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise**

assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203).

A. "Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies." B. Pluralism C. De jure vs de facto sovereignty D. State vs government

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203).** with **State vs government**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 17

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Internal vs external sovereignty**?

A. internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign control in international relations (PDF pp.179-182). B. sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181). C. sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183). D. This maxim is not traceable to Gauba or to the Socio-Political Philosophy Kautilya synopsis used here; it is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston. Treat any such attribution as unsafe and answer via the verified seven-limbed-state material instead (see §6).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Internal vs external sovereignty** with **internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign control in international relations (PDF pp.179-182).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 18

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign control in international relations (PDF pp.179-182).**

A. Sovereignty B. Internal vs external sovereignty C. Monistic sovereignty D. Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign control in international relations (PDF pp.179-182).** with **Internal vs external sovereignty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 19

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **De jure vs de facto sovereignty**?

A. about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign state from foreign control. B. sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist formulation (PDF pp.183-185). C. de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188). D. supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **De jure vs de facto sovereignty** with **de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 20

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188).**

A. Legal sovereignty B. The five classical characteristics of sovereignty C. Sovereignty vs power D. De jure vs de facto sovereignty

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188).** with **De jure vs de facto sovereignty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 21

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty**?

A. legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193). B. people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return to anarchy (PDF pp.182-183). C. Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203). D. Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty** with **legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193).**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 22

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193).**

A. Political sovereignty B. Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty C. State vs government D. State vs association

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193).** with **Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 23

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Sovereignty vs power**?

A. people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense (PDF p.182). B. MacIver concludes that the state should coordinate and resolve conflicts between associations rather than determine their purposes, because the "common interest" is never exhaustively represented by the state alone - the partial interests of many associations are also part of it (PDF pp.204-206). C. Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187). D. The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Sovereignty vs power** with **Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 24

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187)**.

A. Popular sovereignty B. Internal vs external sovereignty C. Bodin D. Sovereignty vs power

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187)**. with **Sovereignty vs power**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 25

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **State vs association**?

A. pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority. B. the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193). C. the supplied Socio-Political Philosophy synopsis D. The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **State vs association** with **pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 26

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority**.

A. Pluralism B. State vs association C. De jure vs de facto sovereignty D. Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law")

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority**. with **State vs association**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 27

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Bodin**?

A. sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183). B. This maxim is not traceable to Gauba or to the Socio-Political Philosophy Kautilya synopsis used here; it is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston. Treat any such attribution as unsafe and answer via the verified seven-limbed-state material instead (see §6). C. sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181). D. the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Bodin** with **sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181)**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 28

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181)**.

A. Monistic sovereignty B. Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty C. Hobbes D. Bodin

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181)**. with **Bodin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 29

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law")**?

A. about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign state from foreign control. B. sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist formulation (PDF pp.183-185). C. supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180). D. the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law")** with **about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign state from foreign control**.. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 30

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign state from foreign control**.

A. The five classical characteristics of sovereignty B. Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law") C. Sovereignty vs power D. Locke

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign state from foreign control**. with **Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law")**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 31

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Hobbes**?

A. Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203). B. Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190). C. people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return to anarchy (PDF pp.182-183). D. These five attributes

should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Hobbes** with **people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return to anarchy** (PDF pp.182-183).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 32

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return to anarchy** (PDF pp.182-183).

A. State vs government B. State vs association C. Rousseau D. Hobbes

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **people create a sovereign for order, peace and security; once created, sovereign authority is near-irrevocable because challenge risks a return to anarchy** (PDF pp.182-183). with **Hobbes**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 33

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Locke**?

A. people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense (PDF p.182). B. MacIver concludes that the state should coordinate and resolve conflicts between associations rather than determine their purposes, because the "common interest" is never exhaustively represented by the state alone - the partial interests of many associations are also part of it (PDF pp.204-206). C. The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190). D. sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Locke** with **people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense** (PDF p.182).. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 34

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense** (PDF p.182).

A. Internal vs external sovereignty B. Locke C. Bodin D. Bentham

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **people retain fundamental natural rights and remain supreme; ruler or government cannot be sovereign in the Hobbesian sense** (PDF p.182). with **Locke**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 35

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Rousseau**?

A. the supplied Socio-Political Philosophy synopsis B. The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193). C. the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193). D. internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign control in international relations (PDF pp.179-182).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Rousseau** with **the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 36

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193)**.

A. De jure vs de facto sovereignty B. Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law") C. Austin D. Rousseau

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the people themselves are sovereign through the general will; government is only an agent and cannot logically claim sovereignty (PDF pp.182-193)** with **Rousseau**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 37

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Bentham**?

A. sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183). B. This maxim is not traceable to Gauba or to the Socio-Political Philosophy Kautilya synopsis used here; it is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston. Treat any such attribution as unsafe and answer via the verified seven-limbed-state material instead (see §6). C. the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198). D. de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Bentham** with **sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 38

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183)**.

A. Legal vs political vs popular sovereignty B. Bentham C. Hobbes D. Laski

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **sovereignty is legally unbound but morally limited, and resistance may sometimes be justified if utility is violated (PDF p.183)** with **Bentham**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 39

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Austin**?

A. supreme legal authority of the state; the power to issue binding laws, commands and decisions within jurisdiction, and to remain independent from external control (PDF pp.179-180). B. the classical view from Bodin to Austin that sovereignty is one, supreme, indivisible and located in a definite person or body (PDF pp.194-195). C. sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist formulation (PDF pp.183-185). D. legal sovereignty is the formal law-making superior; political sovereignty is the effective power behind it; popular sovereignty places ultimate authority in the people (PDF pp.189-193).

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Austin** with **sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist formulation (PDF pp.183-185)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 40

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist formulation (PDF pp.183-185)**.

A. Sovereignty vs power B. Locke C. MacIver D. Austin

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **sovereignty is a determinate human superior habitually obeyed and not habitually obedient to a like superior; this is the strongest legal-monist formulation (PDF pp.183-185)** with **Austin**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 41

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Laski**?

A. Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203). B. Definite, organized and sanction-backed authority recognized by law; closest to Austin's formulation (PDF pp.183-190). C. These five attributes should be read as the classical/Austinian doctrine taken together, not as isolated claims unique to one thinker - Bodin supplies "absolute and perpetual"; the fuller five-part list is Gauba's consolidated exposition of the same monist tradition. D. Gauba resolves the federalism puzzle by distinguishing sovereignty, which remains single, from powers, which may be distributed among organs and levels of government (PDF pp.186-187).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Laski** with **Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 42

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203)**.

A. State vs association B. Laski C. Rousseau D. Kautilya (secondary-source comparator)

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Alongside this three-front attack, Laski separately builds a moral argument: he distinguishes state from government (the state's powers are only ever exercised by fallible officials who "may deliberately exploit the authority they possess"), and argues that because society is itself "federal" (an association of associations), "authority must be federal also" - sovereignty should be coordinative and shared according to function, not hierarchical and omnipotent (PDF pp.201-203)** with **Laski**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 43

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **MacIver**?

A. The effective power behind the legal sovereign; Dicey's "other sovereign" to which formal authority must bow (PDF pp.189-190). B. sovereignty belongs to the state as an abstract continuing entity; governments are changing agents that exercise assigned powers (PDF pp.185-187, 202-203). C. MacIver concludes that the state should coordinate and resolve conflicts between associations rather than determine their purposes, because the "common interest" is never exhaustively represented by the state alone - the partial interests of many associations are also part of it (PDF pp.204-206). D. pluralists do not deny that the state has compulsory jurisdiction; they deny that this legal superiority automatically proves total moral superiority.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **MacIver** with **MacIver concludes that the state should coordinate and resolve conflicts between associations rather than determine their purposes, because the "common interest" is never exhaustively represented by the state alone - the partial interests of many associations are also part of it (PDF pp.204-206)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 44

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **MacIver concludes that the state should coordinate and resolve conflicts between associations rather than determine their purposes, because the "common interest" is never exhaustively represented by the state alone - the partial interests of many associations are also part of it (PDF pp.204-206)**.

A. Bodin B. Bentham C. "Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies." D. MacIver

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **MacIver concludes that the state should coordinate and resolve conflicts between associations rather than determine their purposes, because the "common interest" is never exhaustively represented by the state alone - the partial interests of many associations are also part of it (PDF pp.204-206)** with **MacIver**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 45

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **Kautilya (secondary-source comparator)**?

A. the supplied Socio-Political Philosophy synopsis B. The people in corporate capacity are the source of authority; government is their agent, not the sovereign itself (PDF pp.182-193). C. internal sovereignty means supremacy over persons and associations inside the territory; external sovereignty means independence from foreign control in international relations (PDF pp.179-182). D. sovereignty is absolute and perpetual; the sovereign is source of law, though not freed from duty or moral responsibility altogether (PDF p.181).

Answer: A

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **Kautilya (secondary-source comparator)** with **the supplied Socio-Political Philosophy synopsis**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 46

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **the supplied Socio-Political Philosophy synopsis**

A. Grotius (Dutch jurist, "father of international law") B. Kautilya (secondary-source comparator) C. Austin D. Sovereignty

Answer: B

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **the supplied Socio-Political Philosophy synopsis** with **Kautilya (secondary-source comparator)**. The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 47

Which option correctly states the source-grounded meaning or position associated with **"Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies."**?

A. the view that important associations in society embody values and claims not wholly created by the state, so the state cannot be treated as morally all-comprehensive (PDF pp.196-198). B. de jure refers to legal title; de facto refers to actual effective control, especially in revolutionary situations (PDF pp.187-188). C. This maxim is not traceable to Gauba or to the Socio-Political Philosophy Kautilya synopsis used here; it is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston. Treat any such attribution as unsafe and answer via the verified seven-limbed-state material instead (see §6). D. about half a century after Bodin, Grotius extended sovereignty into the external/international sphere - independence of the sovereign state from foreign control.

Answer: C

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **"Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies."** with **This maxim is not traceable to Gauba or to the Socio-Political Philosophy Kautilya synopsis used here; it is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston. Treat any such attribution as unsafe and answer via the verified seven-limbed-state material instead (see §6).** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

MCQ 48

Which concept, thinker or distinction is correctly associated with this source-grounded statement: **This maxim is not traceable to Gauba or to the Socio-Political Philosophy Kautilya synopsis used here; it is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston. Treat any such attribution as unsafe and answer via the verified seven-limbed-state material instead (see §6).**

A. Hobbes B. Laski C. Legal sovereignty D. "Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies."

Answer: D

Explanation: The canonical Basic owner pairs **This maxim is not traceable to Gauba or to the Socio-Political Philosophy Kautilya synopsis used here; it is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston. Treat any such attribution as unsafe and answer via the verified seven-limbed-state material instead (see §6).** with **"Kautilya said states have no permanent friends or enemies."** The other options are valid source terms or statements, but belong to different pairings.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Cross-application ownership note: These are verified Philosophy Optional questions whose primary owner is Philosophy Paper II - Sovereignty. They are not re-routed to Political Theory; they are included because this topic provides a directly usable supporting framework.

Solved PYQ 8 - 2022 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: What arguments does Bodin present to contend that sovereignty must be absolute, perpetual and undivided? Is Bodin's conception of sovereignty compatible with the social and political ideals of equality, justice and liberty? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. Bodin argues sovereignty must be *absolute, perpetual and undivided* to end civil war; but measured against equality, justice and liberty his conception is only partly compatible -- historically foundational, normatively problematic.

PART A - the arguments.

- **Absolute.** To end faction the sovereign must have no human superior within the commonwealth and be able to make and unmake law without consent -- yet he is still bound by divine law, natural law and the *leges imperii*.
- **Perpetual.** Sovereignty attaches to the *office*, not a temporary

magistrate, so authority persists across rulers and cannot be reclaimed by those who conferred it.

- **Undivided.** If two authorities were each final, their conflict could reopen

the disorder Bodin means to close; hence one final law-making centre.

PART B - compatibility with the ideals.

- **Tension conceded.** Concentrated final authority offers weak guarantees

against the abuse that equality, justice and liberty are designed to check; the higher-law limits are conceptually real but institutionally soft.

- **Partial defence.** Bodin's order-first logic secures the civil peace without

which no ideal is realisable, and his higher-law limits deny pure caprice.

Verdict. Bodin is the indispensable founder of the modern doctrine, but his absolutism is compatible with the ideals only where those limits genuinely bind; modern equality, justice and liberty require the institutional checks -- constitutional supremacy, rights, judicial review -- that Bodin's scheme lacks.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks - it runs each attribute with its argument (Part A), then grades compatibility honestly (Part B), conceding the absolute-vs-bound tension instead of defending or dismissing Bodin wholesale.

Solved PYQ 9 - 2023 Q2(a), 20 marks

Question: Elucidate why the absolute nature of sovereignty was rejected by Laski.

Model solution

Thesis. Laski rejects the *absolute* nature of sovereignty because it is, in his three-fold indictment, philosophically *false*, politically *dangerous* and sociologically *unreal* -- and because human loyalty is genuinely plural.

- **False.** No body -- not even the state -- deserves the unlimited, unconditional

obedience that absolute sovereignty demands; allegiance must be *earned* by protecting rights and delivering welfare, not *owed* to a metaphysical supremacy.

- **Dangerous.** Treating one will as final licenses tyranny and overrides

minority rights, local autonomy and individual conscience.

- **Unreal.** Society is a web of associations -- church, union, guild,

profession, locality -- each commanding real loyalty, so power is *already* dispersed; monism misdescribes the facts.

- **State as one association among many.** Uniquely important, but not morally

supreme; sovereignty should therefore be *divided and shared*, and the state must *compete for allegiance*.

- **Reply to the "shared sovereignty is not sovereignty" objection.** Laski's

point is that the monistic *concept itself* is misleading; theory should mirror the real plurality of authority rather than force it into one pyramid.

Verdict. Laski is an indispensable corrective against absolutism; his own weakness is coordination -- a polity that never speaks with one voice may struggle in emergency, defence and redistribution. He remains a pluralist, not an anarchist.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks - it elucidates FALSE/DANGEROUS/UNREAL as the reasons for rejection, adds "one association among many" and "earned allegiance," and pre-empts the shared-sovereignty objection.

Solved PYQ 10 - 2024 Q4(b), 15 marks

Question: What insights does the Arthashastra offer with regard to the concept of sovereignty? Does it have any relevance in the modern times? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Thesis. The *Arthashastra* offers a rich, realist science of sovereignty -- *saptanga*, *dandaniti*, *mandala*, *sadgunya* and *yogakshema* -- whose *themes* remain strikingly relevant, provided they are appropriated by theme rather than

transposed literally.

- **The insights.** Sovereignty as *state capacity*: seven interdependent limbs with the *svami* as head; calibrated coercion (*dandaniti*) between anarchy and tyranny; external survival through the *mandala* circle and the six-fold *sadgunya* policy; and the overriding aim of *yogakshema* -- security plus the

welfare of subjects.

- **Why it is relevant.** Kautilya refuses the false choice between moralism and realism: durable power rests on administrative competence, fiscal strength, intelligence, strategic balancing *and* legitimacy through welfare -- concerns every modern state shares.

- **The caution.** The *form* is monarchical and the methods sometimes ruthless; relevance lies in the underlying principles of statecraft, not in reproducing ancient kingship or espionage practice.

Verdict. The *Arthashastra* is highly relevant as a theory of effective, welfare-oriented, strategically prudent statecraft; its value is thematic and principled, and must be separated from its dated institutional form.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks - it lists concrete insights, argues relevance by theme (capacity, welfare, strategy), and adds the transposition caution instead of claiming ancient monarchy maps directly onto the present.

Solved PYQ 11 - 2025 Q2(c), 15 marks

Question: 'There is no permanent friend or permanent enemy.' Discuss this statement in the light of Kautilya's view on Sovereignty.

Model solution

Thesis. The proposition in the question should not be silently presented as Kautilya's own maxim. It is not traceable to the Gauba or Kautilya synopsis used here and is more reliably associated with Lord Palmerston. The defensible answer should flag that attribution problem and then ask whether verified Kautilyan statecraft supports a related logic of strategic flexibility.

- **Attribution discipline.** State the caution before interpretation: the wording is unsafe as a settled Kautilya quotation. This prevents a question's framing from becoming fabricated textual ownership.
- **Verified external framework.** Kautilya's *mandala* analyses relations among neighbouring and more distant powers through position, capacity and interest. Alliances and rivalries can consequently change with circumstances, but this is an analytical inference from the framework, not proof that Kautilya authored the quoted maxim.
- **Policy toolkit.** Strategic choice is organised through *sadgunya*: *sandhi* (peace), *vigraha* (war), *yana* (march), *asana* (remaining poised), *samsraya* (seeking shelter or alliance) and *dvaividhibhava* (dual policy). Their use depends on relative strength and the preservation of the realm.
- **Internal sovereignty and limit.** Kautilya's *saptanga* account treats rule as the coordinated health of ruler, ministers, territory and people, fortified centre, treasury, force and ally. *Danda* is therefore embedded in administrative capacity and *yogakshema*, not licensed as normless expediency.

Verdict. The quotation's attribution should be rejected as unverified. A qualified conceptual parallel may still be drawn: verified *mandala* and *sadgunya* reasoning makes external policy relational and adaptable, while *saptanga* and *yogakshema* tie sovereignty to the ordered preservation and welfare of the state.

MEMORY: Why this earns marks - it corrects the attribution explicitly, answers through verified *mandala*, *sadgunya* and *saptanga* material, and distinguishes a cautious conceptual parallel from a fabricated quotation.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original Mains Practice 1 - 10 marks

Question: What is sovereignty, and why must legal, political and popular sovereignty be distinguished? Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Sovereignty denotes final public authority, but legal, political and popular sovereignty identify different locations and dimensions of that authority.

Core analysis: Legal sovereignty is the determinate, law-recognised organ whose enactments count as binding. Political sovereignty is the effective power to which formal lawmakers must respond, such as an electorate, party organisation or organised public opinion. Popular sovereignty is the normative doctrine that the people in their corporate capacity are the ultimate source of legitimate authority and that government remains their agent. A parliament may therefore be legally supreme while politically constrained and democratically derivative.

Critical evaluation: The distinctions prevent legal validity, social influence and legitimacy from being collapsed. Constitutional democracy connects them through authorised institutions, elections, rights and public accountability, even though their alignment is never perfect.

Conclusion: Sovereignty is intelligible only when final legal competence, effective political influence and the people's legitimating authorship are distinguished and constitutionally connected.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 2 - 10 marks

Question: Reconstruct Bodin's case for absolute, perpetual and undivided sovereignty. Answer in about 150 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Bodin developed sovereignty to identify a continuing and final source of law capable of holding a conflict-ridden commonwealth together.

Core analysis: Sovereignty is absolute because no rival human authority within the polity can legally overrule it; perpetual because it belongs to the continuing commonwealth rather than a temporary magistrate; and indivisible because two independent final law-makers would make authoritative settlement impossible. The sovereign legislates, declares war and peace, appoints officers and judges in the last instance. These attributes distinguish sovereignty from delegated powers exercised for a term or under another's authorization.

Critical evaluation: Bodin's absoluteness is juridical rather than a defence of arbitrary appetite because the sovereign remains bound by divine and natural law and fundamental obligations. Yet unenforceable moral limits may not adequately restrain final power.

Conclusion: Bodin's doctrine secures the legal unity and continuity of the commonwealth, but its morally stated limits require institutional form if finality is not to become arbitrary power.

Why this earns marks: It defines the issue, states the controlling distinction, adds one limitation and closes with a direct verdict suited to a 10-mark answer.

Original Mains Practice 3 - 15 marks

Question: Critically examine Austin's command theory of sovereignty. Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Austin gives the classical legal-monist thesis its most precise form by locating positive law in commands issued by a determinate human superior.

Core analysis: The sovereign receives habitual obedience from the bulk of society and is not habitually obedient to a like superior. Law is the sovereign's general command backed by sanction, providing a clear criterion for distinguishing positive law from morality. The theory illuminates legal hierarchy and the need for ultimate settlement where commands conflict. It also avoids disguising moral approval as a condition of legal existence.

Further development: Hart's later distinction between a gunman's threat and a legal system sharpens the objection: modern law contains power-conferring and secondary rules that cannot be reduced to coercive commands. Constitutional officials also obey rules identifying valid authority rather than habitually obeying a personally determinate superior. Austin nevertheless isolates a real problem-how a legal order closes disputes about validity. His theory should therefore be retained as a simplified model of final legal competence while its command, sanction and personal-superior elements are revised.

Critical evaluation: Its social picture is too simple for constitutional government, federal distribution, custom and international law. Obedience is mediated by offices and rules, and continuity survives changing officeholders. Austin remains useful as an account of legal finality, not a complete sociology or ethics of political obligation.

Conclusion: Austin remains a sharp account of legal finality, but constitutional rules, institutional continuity and plural social authority prevent it from becoming a complete theory of the modern state.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 4 - 15 marks

Question: Why did Laski reject absolute sovereignty, and does pluralism preserve political order? Answer in about 200 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Laski rejects absolute sovereignty because legal supremacy does not establish unlimited effective power, exclusive social value or unconditional moral obligation.

Core analysis: Historically, custom and inherited institutions constrain rulers; internationally, interdependence and law limit unilateral action; morally, citizens owe loyalty to purposes and associations not created by the state. Family, church, union and professional body possess genuine authority within their spheres. The state cannot claim that every valid social end derives from its will, nor can law alone settle whether obedience is justified. Pluralism thus replaces a command pyramid with multiple centres of social loyalty.

Further development: The strongest pluralist position is functional rather than territorial anarchy. Different associations possess authority because they pursue distinctive goods and organise real practices, but none automatically receives immunity from common law. Public authority remains responsible for resolving external conflicts, guaranteeing exit and protecting members whose group is itself oppressive. This reply preserves plural loyalty without romanticising every association. It also explains why Laski's critique is directed against unlimited supremacy, not against every form of state coordination.

Critical evaluation: Fragmentation remains a serious objection. Pluralism preserves order only if the state retains residual coordination, protects individuals against internal group domination and secures common goods without claiming moral omnipotence.

Conclusion: Laski's pluralism preserves order only when denial of moral omnipotence is joined to a rights-bound state with residual responsibility for coordination and adjudication.

Why this earns marks: It combines definition, named doctrinal evidence, comparison and a counter-position before giving a qualified 15-mark verdict.

Original Mains Practice 5 - 20 marks

Question: Can sovereignty remain one while governmental powers are divided in a federation? Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Federalism divides constitutionally assigned powers, but that need not imply several independent sovereigns within one legal order.

Core analysis: A constitution allocates legislative, executive and fiscal competences between central and regional governments and creates adjudicative mechanisms for boundary disputes. Classical theory can describe sovereignty as belonging to the continuing constitutional state or constituent people while governments exercise limited powers under it. This separates the ultimate validity of the constitutional order from the many authorised centres that govern

within their fields. Shared rule and self-rule alter how authority is exercised without necessarily multiplying final legal systems.

Further development: The Indian case can be used cautiously as an institutional illustration rather than proof of one metaphysical theory. The GST Council joins Union and State governments in continuing fiscal coordination under a common constitutional framework. Its bargaining and shared decision processes show that public power can be dispersed, negotiated and mutually dependent. They do not by themselves settle where constituent sovereignty lies. Federal practice therefore supports a distinction between one legal order, several constitutionally protected governments and multiple centres of political influence.

Critical evaluation: The distinction becomes formalistic if it ignores political bargaining, asymmetric autonomy or practical incapacity. Yet calling every powerful unit sovereign obscures the common framework that makes federal claims enforceable.

Conclusion: Federalism divides and checks the exercise of public power without necessarily multiplying the ultimate constitutional orders from which those powers derive.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.

Original Mains Practice 6 - 20 marks

Question: Distinguish internal from external sovereignty in an age of international interdependence. Answer in about 250 words.

Model solution

Introduction: Internal sovereignty concerns final authority within a territory, while external sovereignty concerns independence from foreign control and juridical equality among states.

Core analysis: Internally, the state claims compulsory jurisdiction over persons and associations and resolves conflicts through law. Externally, it enters relations without being legally subordinate to another state. Treaties, international organisations, markets and security commitments constrain choices, but a voluntarily accepted rule is not identical to colonial subjection. Interdependence can enlarge effective capacity by allowing states to achieve common goals through cooperation. Formal independence and practical autonomy must therefore be separated.

Further development: Three layers prevent an all-or-nothing conclusion. Juridical sovereignty concerns recognition and legal equality; empirical sovereignty concerns administrative and economic capacity; democratic sovereignty concerns whether binding commitments are authorised and contestable. A formally independent but heavily dependent state may possess the first while lacking the second, and a powerful state may possess capacity while evading democratic control. Treaties can pool capacity without destroying status when commitments are reciprocal, transparent and revisable. Interdependence therefore transforms the exercise and effectiveness of sovereignty more clearly than its formal existence.

Critical evaluation: The classical language of unrestricted independence is misleading, yet sovereignty has not disappeared. Unequal bargaining and coercive dependency can erode meaningful autonomy even where juridical equality remains.

Conclusion: Contemporary sovereignty combines internal constitutional authority and external equal status with negotiated obligations, while remaining alert to coercive dependence that empties formal freedom.

Why this earns marks: It develops multiple dimensions and named evidence units, tests the strongest objection and reply, and reaches a balanced 20-mark judgment.